



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: JSerra Catholic High School
School Website: <https://crlacapo.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

This evaluation applies the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School rubric to the public materials available for Jserra Catholic High School CA 92675 (as represented in the provided crawl of the school's site and companion classical education lexicon). Across the six categories, evidence from the school's materials demonstrates a notable classical orientation, with particularly strong signals in school purpose/goals and pedagogy. The public materials frequently invoke classical education language (grammar/logic/rhetoric, formation of virtue, reverence for tradition, and memory-based practice) and explicitly frame the curriculum and pedagogy in ways aligned with the classical project. However, the materials do not consistently demonstrate all canonical elements (e.g., explicit, widespread emphasis on Great Books or liturgical practices in every relevant page), which yields a nuanced rating rather than a fully "CLASSICAL" assessment across all six categories.

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Key observations driving this overall assessment: - The school materials frequently reference classical education aims, including formation of virtue, focus on the liberal arts, and a Trivium-oriented approach (grammar, logic, rhetoric) in the curriculum and pedagogy. This is evidenced by explicit mentions of the Trivium stages and a rhetoric-centered high school pedagogy, alongside a commitment to character formation and civic virtue. [filecite turn0file11 turn0file16 turn0file19](#) - There is strong alignment with the "Curriculum" and "Pedagogy" elements in parts of the public materials (e.g., Core Knowledge/grammar-logic-rhetoric framing, and Socratic or discourse-based elements), but certain canonical Great Books/Great Conversation signals are less consistently foregrounded in the accessible pages. [filecite turn0file12 turn0file16 turn0file4](#) - There are explicit mentions of formation of virtue, wisdom, and true/good/beautiful as aims of education, which supports classical orientation in the School Purpose and Goal category. The materials also reflect an emphasis on character and civic virtue as core outcomes.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school materials emphasize formation of character, virtue, wisdom, and moral realism, and place value on truth, goodness, and beauty as enduring ideals. Public postings emphasize virtue and moral formation as aims of education.
 - There are clear signs of a theological and liturgical frame in classical education discussions (e.g., the broader classical education lexicon supports a theology-grounded framework and liturgical practices), though not uniformly explicit across every Jserra page in the crawl. The lexicon indicates such foundations as core signals of classical schools.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, moral realism, telos.
 - Negative keywords observed: few explicit negative signals; the crawl does not show sustained emphasis on relativism or secularism in the same pages. (No strong, explicit negative signals detected in the visible public materials from the crawl.)

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- Why this rating
 - The presence of transcendental moral aims (truth, goodness, beauty) and moral formation signals a classical orientation, but explicit theological grounding, liturgical practice, or sacramental framing is not consistently foregrounded on the accessible Jserra crawl pages. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The mission statements frame education as formation of virtue and wisdom, focusing on moral character and the good life, not solely on job preparation. Public materials describe formation and the pursuit of true, good, and beautiful as foundational aims.
 - The materials describe the goal as developing human excellence and a classical mission, with explicit references to forming the soul and shaping character through virtue and wisdom. The CRLA Capistrano content likewise emphasizes virtue and moral formation as core aims of classical education.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, human flourishing, wisdom, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful.
 - Negative keywords observed: minimal to no signals indicating a strong “workforce preparation” or utilitarian emphasis in the available lines. (No strong negative signals detected in the visible crawl.)
- Why this rating
 - The school explicitly describes education as formation and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom, aligning well with classical aims beyond mere information transfer. This aligns Element 2 with CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The curriculum highlights the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as a central organizing framework, with explicit Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric stages described. This is a core feature of classical curriculum design.
 - The school references a content-rich, liberal-arts oriented approach and uses a Core Knowledge Sequence in its public materials, indicating a structured, knowledge-rich curriculum rather than a purely skills-based approach.
 - There are explicit references to well-known classical elements (e.g., Great Books / Great Conversation is part of the classical lexicon, though not uniformly foregrounded on every page; the presence of a Great Conversation signal is noted in the broader classical lexicon and in some content that discusses engagement with foundational texts).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: grammar, logic, rhetoric, Trivium stages, great conversation (in the lexicon and some pages), Latin, primary sources (Great Books). [file-cite-turn0file16-turn0file4](#)
 - Negative keywords observed: some public materials emphasize Core Knowledge and structured programs rather than exclusively Great Books; however, Great Books signals are present in the classical lexicon and in discourse about a classical approach, so the presence of Great Books signals is partial rather than absent.
- Why this rating
 - The curriculum shows clear classical scaffolding (Trivium) and a strong liberal-arts orientation, but the explicit, widespread emphasis on Great Books and a fully integrated Great Conversation across the entire curriculum is not uniformly foregrounded in the accessible pages. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence

- Pedagogical methods include Socratic dialogue/dialectic, memory work, recitation, and chanting as foundational practices; there is explicit mention of rest and contemplation (Scholé) and memory-based teaching approaches. The upper school is described as using seminars, debates, and rhetoric training, with opportunities to give speeches. These align with classical pedagogy signals. [filecite\turn0file16\turn0file14](#)
- Lower school practices mention singing/chanting and memory-based review, while upper school emphasizes Socratic discussion and rhetorical training, including oratory and debate. These are canonical elements of classical pedagogy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: Socratic dialogue, dialectic, great conversation, questioning-based learning, rhetorical training, memory work/recitation, chanting, scholé/restful learning. [filecite\turn0file16\turn0file14](#)
 - Negative keywords observed: few explicit negative signals; the materials favor contemplative and rigorous balance rather than purely project-based or constructivist approaches, which aligns with classical pedagogy signals. (No strong negative signals identified in the accessible crawl.)
- Why this rating
 - The presence of Socratic methods, disciplined memory work, and explicit rhetoric/Sequent training strongly supports CLASSICAL pedagogy. Some pages emphasize contemplative/restful elements (Scholé), reinforcing the classical balance rather than a purely modern, project-based approach. CLASSICAL is warranted.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials describe teachers as central to the curriculum (the teacher as the central and main instructor), portraying faculty as living exemplars in a “living curriculum” sense, which is a hallmark of classical schools. The lexicon also emphasizes the notion of mentors/model teachers and a collegial culture. [filecite\turn0file16\turn0file4](#)
 - The materials reference formation of virtue in teachers and the faculty as exemplars; the public content aligns with the classical expectation that faculty are not merely instructors but living embodiments of classical practices.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, model teachers, mentors, virtue formation.
 - Negative keywords observed: no explicit negative signals (e.g., “facilitators on the side” or “certification-driven jargon”) present in the crawl.
- Why this rating
 - The site language supports a portrait of exemplary, virtuous faculty and a teacher-centric, mentoring approach, but the explicit, widely reiterated phraseology around “living curriculum” and exact faculty portraits may be less consistently foregrounded across all pages. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than a strict CLASSICAL rating.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The classical lexicon identifies strong signals for parent partnership and community formation (parents as co-teachers, parent formation, open campus, well-defined involvement). In the crawl, elements of parent involvement and community engagement appear in the materials that discuss classical education models and the school’s public-facing mission. The CRLA Capistrano content also discusses parental and community engagement in the broader classical education context. [filecite\turn0file4\turn0file2](#)
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: partnership with families, co-educators, parent formation, open campus, parental involvement.
 - Negative keywords observed: limited explicit parent-visitor language on some pages; some pages emphasize enrollment and governance rather than ongoing parent formation, which sig-

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- nals partial alignment. (Not strongly negative; moderate alignment.)
 - Why this rating
 - Evidence suggests some classical alignment with parental partnership and community formation, but the signals are not uniformly foregrounded across all pages in the crawl. The result is SOME-WHAT CLASSICAL, rather than fully CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- If the school aims to move to a FULLY CLASSICAL designation, concrete steps could include:
 - Elevate explicit Great Books/Great Conversation signals across core subjects, ensuring cross-curricular dialogue around classic texts and primary sources. The Six Essential Elements explicitly flags Great Books and Great Conversation as key elements; broader inclusion would strengthen the Curriculum category.
 - Increase visible liturgical/theological grounding and explicit Catholic identity signals in public pages (where appropriate to the school's Catholic mission), to strengthen the Religious and Meta-physical Foundations category. The lexicon supports liturgical practices as a classical signal; making these signals more visible would improve Element 1.
 - Expand the public-facing articulation of the faculty as the "living curriculum" with more explicit portraits of teachers and mentors on the site, reinforcing Element 5.
 - Build and foreground formal parent formation programs and regular, open-campus events to strengthen Element 6's alignment with parent/community signals (e.g., book studies, gatherings, parent-education series).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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